

Decory Edwards
Johns Hopkins University
Department of Economics

December 25, 2025

Hiring Committee
IBM Consulting

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am writing to apply for the Associate Business Transformation Consultant position through the IBM Consulting Associate Program. I am currently a PhD candidate in Economics at Johns Hopkins University. My training combines quantitative analysis, structured problem solving, and clear communication. I am motivated by problems that require careful framing, disciplined analysis, and practical solutions that translate strategy into execution. IBM Consulting's focus on business transformation at the intersection of technology, people, and process aligns closely with how I approach analytical work.

My research agenda is at the intersection of wealth inequality and macroeconomics. In my job market paper, I build and estimate a structural heterogeneous agent model with returns that differ across households. The core contribution is to show how heterogeneity in returns and income risk jointly shape the wealth distribution and consumption behavior. Relative to closely related work, my framework performs better at matching the lower and middle portions of the wealth distribution. This difference matters quantitatively. Models that focus primarily on returns heterogeneity can fit the top of the wealth distribution closely but tend to generate too much wealth among the bottom half of households. In my framework, income uncertainty generates a precautionary saving motive that produces genuinely low wealth households. This leads to a realistic distribution of marginal propensities to consume and aggregate consumption responses that align with empirical estimates.

A key feature of my research is translating complex analysis into actionable insights. I identify objectives, gather and structure data from multiple sources, and design analyses that support clear recommendations. I regularly communicate results to diverse audiences and tailor messaging to stakeholder needs. This work requires adaptability, attention to detail, and collaboration in fast paced environments, skills that map directly to business transformation consulting.

I am particularly interested in IBM Consulting because of its emphasis on continuous learning, mentorship, and impact at scale. The opportunity to work across industries, apply design thinking, and collaborate with technologists and business leaders to deliver measurable value is especially appealing. I value environments that encourage curiosity, challenge assumptions, and support long term professional growth.

My economics training has provided a strong foundation in analytical reasoning, quantitative methods, and structured communication. I am comfortable analyzing data to support business cases, translating requirements into solutions, and working collaboratively in agile teams. I take pride in delivering clear, client ready work and in learning new tools and frameworks quickly.

I am enthusiastic about joining IBM Consulting through the Associate Program and contributing in person within a collaborative consulting environment. I see this role as an opportunity to apply

my analytical training to help clients adapt to change while building a long term career at IBM.

I would welcome the opportunity to contribute my skills and perspective to IBM Consulting. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

Decory Edwards